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# DAREDEVILRY AND DELIGHT

**Given India's geographic diversity, it isn't surprising that some of the world's best adventure travel destinations are dotted across the country**

In India, we are blessed with every conceivable geographical terrain, including 73 per cent of a culturally diverse Himalayan range, a global biodiversity hotspot with rich fauna, flora and avifauna. We must leverage our natural heritage in a sustainable manner and aim to be among the 10 best adventure destinations in the world by 2030. The Ministry of Tourism, Government of India, has constituted the National Board for Adventure Tourism, which will be a game-changer for the sustainable development of adventure tourism in the country. Here is a list of my 10 best adventure travel destinations in India.



## Bir Billing

**A magnificent backdrop of the snow-clad Dhauladhar range and ideal flying conditions have made Bir Billing the aerosports capital of India and one of the best paragliding sites on the planet. This is a great place for beginners to learn the fine art of paragliding and also for first-timers to do tandem flights with seasoned professionals.**



## Rishikesh

The yoga capital of the world has become the rafting capital and prime adventure hub of India. The Ganga is a pool and drop river with calm, serene sections between the adrenaline-pumping rapids. The riverine beaches here are a special attraction. Other than river rafting and kayaking, bungee jumping, ziplining across the Ganga, adventure parks and wildlife safaris in Rajaji National Park have made Rishikesh and adjoining areas an attractive destination for adventure-seekers.

## Andaman & Nicobar Islands

*By far the best water sports and scuba diving destination in the country, the clear water, abundant marine life and corals add up to make diving in the Andamans a special experience, ideal for first-timers as well as seasoned pros. Kayaking along the mangrove-lined coast is the best way to explore the archipelago. Night sea kayaking with bioluminescence and visiting Barren Island, an active volcano, are special attractions.*



## Tawang

The entire state of Arunachal Pradesh is abuzz with adventure, with Tawang as the special hub. Getting to Tawang itself is an adventure, crossing Sela Pass at 13,700 ft and visiting the Nuranang Falls at Jung. Visiting Bum La Pass (15,200 ft) on the India-Tibet border, Zimithang (14,000 ft), and Shonga-tser Lake are must-do adventures.





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